

PROJECT TASK 01 OF 03 — THE BASELINE ASSESSMENT

Cyber.SoHo Educational Hub

From the Industry to the Classroom — Building the IT's Future, Today and Together!

Course	Management of Information Systems (IS) Assessment
Module	Module 01 — Week 01: IS (Information Systems) in the Digital Age
Task	Project Task 01 of 03 — <i>The Baseline Assessment</i>
Produces	Part A of your Written Project (the IS Assessment Dossier)
Ponderation	2 – 1 – 3
Working time	4 hours (1 laboratory hour + 3 hours of personal work)
Weight	10% of the final grade, inside the 30% "Continuous Course Assessments" band
Submission	Blackboard → Course → Assignments → DropBox → <i>Task 01</i>
Deadline	Midnight CET (Central European Time), Sunday 16 August 2026
Level	Undergraduate. No prior IS or IT background assumed.
Version	1.0 — August 2026

0. READ THIS FIRST — WHAT YOU ARE ACTUALLY BEING ASKED TO DO

You are going to pick one real system that you personally use — a college portal, a delivery app, a gym booking page, a transit card, a bank app, a library reservation system — and you are going to produce a professional **assessment** of it.

Not a description. Not a review. An assessment.

The difference is the whole point of this course, and it is the thing your grade turns on, so it is worth thirty seconds now.

A **description** says what a system is. A **review** says whether you liked it. An **assessment** says what the system is for, whether it achieves that, how you measured it, what it costs the people it touches, and what you would change first — and it states every one of those claims precisely enough that somebody who disagrees with you could go and check.

That last property has a name: **falsifiability**. A claim is falsifiable when it is stated in a way that evidence could prove wrong. "The booking system is quite good" cannot be argued with, because there is nothing in it to argue about. "Room occupancy went from 41 percent to 68 percent over the same eight weeks before and after launch" can be argued with — and that is exactly why it is worth marks.

You will hear me repeat this. I am not being difficult. Roughly half the marks lost on this task every term are lost to adjectives standing in for measurements.

1. HOW THE FOUR HOURS ARE SHAPED, AND WHY

1.1 What "ponderation 2 – 1 – 3" means

If you have not met the term before: **ponderation** is the three-number code that describes how a course expects you to spend your week. The three numbers are always in the same order.

Number	Stands for	This course
2	Hours of theory per week — the lecture	2 h
1	Hours of laboratory / practical per week — supervised, hands-on	1 h
3	Hours of personal work per week — you, alone, unsupervised	3 h

Total: **six hours a week**. Two of those six are the Week 01 lecture you have already worked through. The remaining four — one lab hour plus three personal hours — **are this task**. That is not a coincidence and it is not padding. The task was built to fill exactly the practical half of the ponderation.

1.2 The four hours, block by block

Work in this order. Each block is designed to be finished in one sitting, and each one produces a piece of the deliverable rather than "progress".

Block	Where	Time	Steps	You finish holding
Lab hour	Classroom / supervised	60 min	1 – 4	A registered subject, 20 minutes of raw notes, a signed declaration, an empty dossier file
Personal 1	Wherever you work	60 min	5 – 6	System anatomy (A1) and process map (A2)
Personal 2	Wherever you work	60 min	7 – 8	Five-forces scorecard (A3) and ethics review (A4)
Personal 3	Wherever you work	60 min	9 – 11	Six-lens baseline (A5), evidence log (A6), open questions (A7), submitted file

Do not merge the blocks into one four-hour sprint the night before. Steps 5 to 8 require you to look back at notes you took in step 2, and you will discover gaps. The gaps are useful. They become your A7 Open Questions, which carry marks. If you do everything at 23:00 on the fifteenth you will have no way to close them and no honest way to admit it.

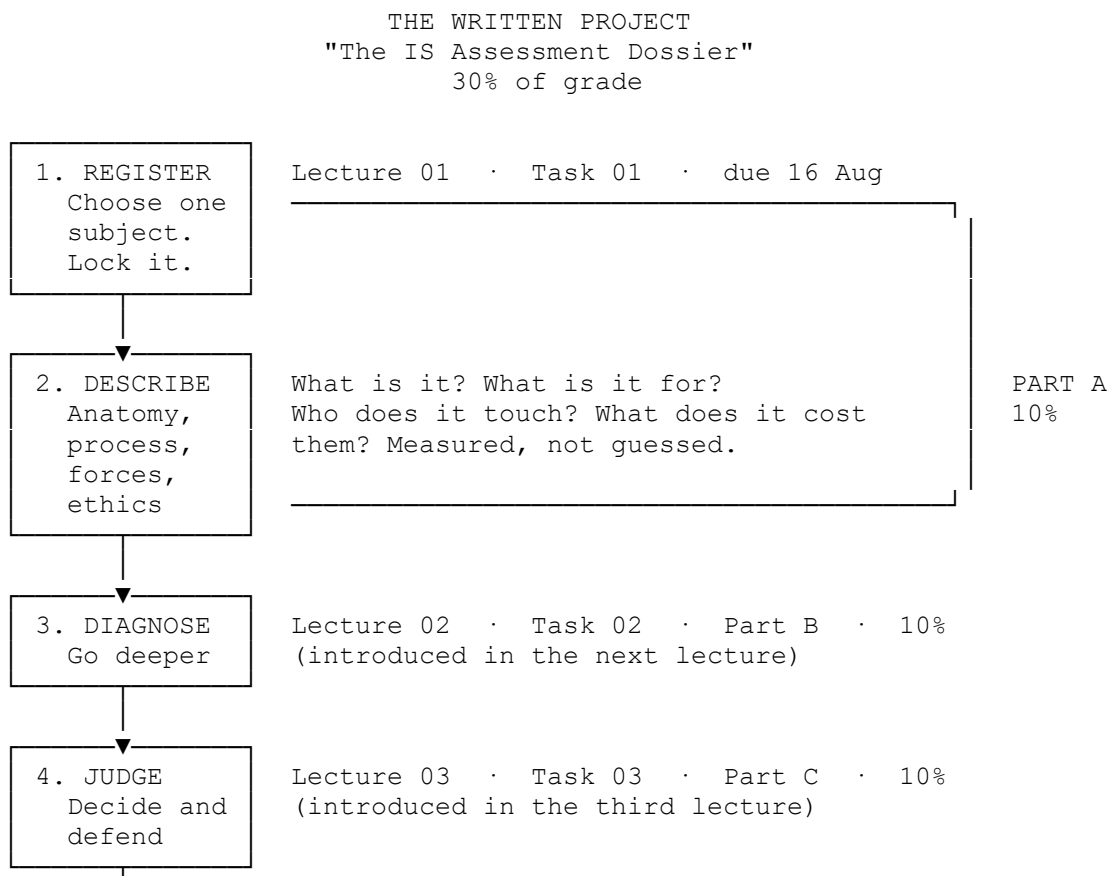
2. WHERE THIS TASK SITS — THE CAPSTONE, EXPLAINED ONCE

This is not a standalone homework. It is the first third of a single piece of work that you will hand in twice: once now, in pieces, and once at the end, assembled.

2.1 The rule that makes it a capstone

One subject. Three passes. You choose your organisation and your system **once**, in Task 01, and you keep both for the entire course. Task 02 and Task 03 go deeper into the same subject. You may not switch. Choose carefully in step 1 — you are marrying it.

2.2 The five stages of the Written Project



5. CONSOLIDATE Lecture 04 · no new task
Merge A + B + C into one dossier. Add the executive
summary and the reflection. Fix what the feedback
on Tasks 01-03 told you to fix.

FULL PROJECT DUE: midnight CET, Friday 28 August 2026

If you prefer a version you can edit, here is the same thing as **Mermaid** (a plain text format that many editors turn into a diagram — see the tools section):

```
flowchart TD
    R[1. REGISTER<br/>choose and lock one subject] --> D[2. DESCRIBE<br/>Part A · Task 01 · 10%]
    D --> G[3. DIAGNOSE<br/>Part B · Task 02 · 10%]
    G --> J[4. JUDGE<br/>Part C · Task 03 · 10%]
    J --> C[5. CONSOLIDATE<br/>full dossier · 28 August]
    D -.feedback.-> C
    G -.feedback.-> C
    J -.feedback.-> C
```

2.3 The arithmetic of your grade

Three tasks, ten percent each, thirty percent total. That thirty percent is recorded in the Course Evaluation Table as **"Continuous Course Assessments"**, and the same thirty percent is what the **"Written Project"** line refers to. They are not two separate things stacked on top of each other. They are one body of work, marked in three instalments as you build it, so that you get corrective feedback twice before the version that counts.

The practical consequence: feedback on Task 01 is not a post-mortem. It is instructions for Task 02. Read it.

3. PLAIN-LANGUAGE TOOLKIT — EVERY TERM YOU NEED, IN ORDINARY WORDS

Most of you are coming from programming courses. The vocabulary below is the part of this field that is genuinely new, and none of it is difficult once somebody says it plainly. Keep this table open while you work.

3.1 The core ideas

Term	In ordinary words
IT (Information Technology)	The machinery: computers, phones, cables, servers, software. Things you can point at or install.

Term	In ordinary words
IS (Information System)	The machinery plus the people, the rules and the habits that surround it. A paper appointment book, a receptionist and a Monday review meeting form an information system with no computer in it at all.
Data	Raw recorded facts with nothing attached. 2026-09-14, JOB-1003, 64.00. On their own they answer no question.
Information	Data organised so it answers a question a person actually asked. "Brake jobs averaged 2.75 hours in September against a 2.0-hour estimate."
Knowledge	Understanding <i>why</i> the information looks that way. Usually lives in a person, not a database. "They overrun because the estimate was written for the old brake type."
Input → Processing → Output → Feedback	The four activities every information system performs. Facts go in, something is done to them, a result reaches a person, and — this is the one beginners forget — the result changes what gets collected next time.
Feedback loop	The fourth activity above. If the output never changes the input, you have a machine that prints reports, not a system.
Business process	A specific sequence of steps, done by specific people, that produces something somebody wants. "Take order → make it → charge for it → restock."
Handoff	The moment work crosses from one person, team or department to another. Handoffs are where information gets lost, delayed or contradicted. Almost everything expensive happens at a handoff.
Information silo	Two parts of an organisation keeping separate records of the same facts. The two records disagree within weeks and nobody is at fault, because there was never a shared record to be right about.
Swimlane diagram	A drawing where each horizontal band ("lane") is one department, and arrows show work crossing between lanes. Every arrow that crosses a lane is a handoff.
Stakeholder	Anybody with an interest in the outcome — including people who never touch the system but are affected by it. The stakeholder you forget is usually the one who makes your assessment wrong.
Metadata	Data <i>about</i> data. Not the message, but who sent it, when, from where, on what device. Frequently more revealing than the message.
KPI (Key Performance Indicator)	A number an organisation has decided to steer by. "Average delivery time." "Tickets closed per week."
Baseline	The measurement you take <i>before</i> changing anything, so that later you can prove something moved. Part A is your baseline.

3.2 The four system types, by who asks the question

Abbreviation	Full name	Who uses it	The question it answers
TPS	Transaction Processing System	Front-line staff, tills, sensors	"Record this sale, this shift, this shipment."
MIS	Management Information System	Middle managers	"How did we do last month against plan?"
DSS	Decision Support System	Analysts, specialists	"What happens if we change this?"
ESS	Executive Support System	Senior management	"Where is this organisation going?"

Data flows **upward** through that table. A till operator who rings everything through as "miscellaneous" because it is faster makes every layer above report confident, well-formatted, wrong answers.

Note that **MIS** means two things: narrowly, the reporting system in the table; broadly, the name of this entire academic field. Context tells you which. When you write, say which you mean.

3.3 The four enterprise applications

These are the four categories of software built specifically to stop information being lost at handoffs.

Abbreviation	Full name	What it is for
ERP	Enterprise Resource Planning	One shared database covering most core functions at once — finance, staff, production, sales — so that when Sales records an order, Finance and Supply see it in the same instant.
SCM	Supply Chain Management	Coordinates suppliers, production and distribution so material arrives when it is needed. Extends the system <i>outside</i> the company's walls.
CRM	Customer Relationship Management	Stores every interaction with a customer, so the relationship survives the salesperson leaving.
KMS	Knowledge Management System	Captures expertise and documents so knowledge survives an employee leaving. The hardest of the four to make work, because it depends on busy people writing things down.

3.4 Strategy vocabulary

Term	In ordinary words
Competitive force	One of five pressures that push money out of a business: rivals, new entrants, substitutes, customers, suppliers. A <i>strong</i> force means value is leaving through that channel.
Substitute	A different way of meeting the same need. A bubble tea shop competes with the canned drinks at the corner store, not only with other bubble tea shops.
Switching cost	What it would cost a customer to leave — money, effort, stored history, saved preferences, accumulated credit. Systems that raise switching costs are a recognised strategy, and also an ethical question.
Transaction cost	What it costs to buy something from outside rather than do it in-house: finding suppliers, negotiating, contracting, checking. When systems lower these, firms get smaller and outsource more.
Agency cost	What it costs an owner to supervise the people working for them. When systems lower these, organisations get flatter.
Complementary assets	The non-software things a system needs to actually work: redesigned processes, training, management backing, incentives that reward using it. Two firms buy identical software; the one with these assets gets results.

3.5 Ethics and law vocabulary

Term / Abbreviation	In ordinary words
The five moral dimensions	Information rights; property rights; accountability and control; system quality; quality of life. Five different <i>kinds</i> of question, not five opinions.
Responsibility	A person accepts the costs and duties of a decision.
Accountability	A mechanism exists to determine who took an action. This is a property of a system, not of a person. No mechanism, no accountability, regardless of who feels responsible.
Liability	A legal framework lets you recover damages. Exists only where the law provides it.
Accountability gap	A system acts, somebody is harmed, and no mechanism can identify which human decision produced it. "The algorithm did it" is a description of the gap, not an explanation of it.
Profiling	Combining several harmless-looking records to build a detailed picture of an individual. Room bookings are not sensitive. Wi-Fi logs are not sensitive. Together they describe where a named person was and with whom.
Data minimisation	Collect only what the stated purpose actually requires. One unnecessary field creates measurable risk all by itself.

Term / Abbreviation	In ordinary words
Informed consent	Agreement given with knowledge of the facts. A consent buried in twelve thousand words is agreement without knowledge, which is not the same thing regardless of what was clicked.
PIPEDA (Personal Information Protection and Electronic Documents Act)	Canada's federal private-sector privacy law.
Law 25 (Québec)	Québec's modernised privacy legislation, phased in from 2022.
GDPR (General Data Protection Regulation)	The European Union's privacy regulation. Reaches organisations outside the EU when they handle EU residents' data.
CCPA (California Consumer Privacy Act)	The most influential United States state privacy law.
FIP (Fair Information Practices)	Not a law — the five principles underneath nearly all privacy law: say what you collect and why; collect only what you need; let people see and correct it; secure it; be accountable for it.
MAC address (Media Access Control address)	The unique hardware identifier of a device's network card. Identifies a device, and a device usually identifies a person.
IP (Intellectual Property)	Legal protection over creations. Three kinds matter here: trade secret, copyright (protects the <i>expression</i> , never the idea), patent.

3.6 Things you will see on the marking sheet

Term	In ordinary words
The six lenses	The marking framework for this whole course: Purpose, People, Process, Strategy, Ethics, Evidence. Ethics and Evidence carry double weight.
Evidence sentence	One sentence naming an observable fact that supports a score. Without it the score is worth zero — not reduced, zero.
Score the weakest lens	When summarising, report the lowest lens, not the average. Averaging hides exactly the thing you were asked to find.
Open question	Something you could not determine, stated honestly, with what you would need to determine it. These earn marks. Pretending you know does not.

4. THE RULES OF ENGAGEMENT — READ BEFORE YOU TOUCH ANYTHING

You are assessing a **real** organisation's system. Some of what you will do resembles, at a distance, what a professional analyst or auditor does with a signed contract and a legal team

behind them. **You have neither.** These rules are not bureaucracy; they are the line between an assignment and a problem.

THE HARD LIMITS — no exceptions, no interpretations

- 1. Observe only as an ordinary user.** Use the system exactly as any member of the public or any enrolled student is entitled to use it. Nothing else.
- 2. No security testing of any kind.** Do not probe, scan, fuzz, inject, enumerate, brute-force, intercept, or "just try" anything. Do not use penetration-testing tools, network scanners, proxies or traffic interceptors against a system you do not own. This is not a security course, this is not a security task, and doing it is potentially a criminal offence under the **Criminal Code of Canada** (unauthorised use of a computer) and equivalent law elsewhere.
- 3. No accessing anything you were not given.** No other person's account. No administrative interface. No "I found an unlisted URL". No credentials that are not yours. If a door opens that should not have, stop, write down the time, and tell your instructor — do not walk through it.
- 4. No scraping, no automation, no bulk collection.** No scripts against a live service. No bypassing rate limits or terms of service. If you want data, take notes by hand, like an auditor with a clipboard.
- 5. Collect no personal data about anybody.** Not classmates, not staff, not customers. If a real person's name, photograph, account, email address, student number or device identifier ends up in your notes, remove it before the notes become part of your dossier. Use role labels — "the counter clerk", "Student B".
- 6. No confidential or internal material.** If you work somewhere, do not use your employer's internal systems, internal documents, or anything covered by a non-disclosure agreement. Your employment obligations outrank this assignment, always.
- 7. Anonymise where there is any doubt.** You may name a large public organisation and a publicly available product. If your subject is small enough that naming it identifies individuals, give it a pseudonym, say that you have done so, and describe the type of organisation instead.
- 8. Do not publish.** Your dossier goes to the Blackboard DropBox and nowhere else. Not a blog, not a repository, not social media. Not now and not after the course.
- 9. If asked to stop, stop.** If any staff member or any notice asks you not to observe, photograph or record — stop immediately and choose a different subject. A refused subject costs you fifteen minutes. Pushing past a refusal costs considerably more.
- 10. When in doubt, ask first and act second.** Nobody has ever lost marks for asking. Ask in the course forum so the answer helps everybody.

A note on why this matters more than usual here. The techniques in this course are the same techniques used in real organisational audits. The distance between "a student mapping a booking process" and "an unauthorised assessment of a live production system" is the permission, not the method. Stay firmly on the side of observation that any ordinary user is entitled to perform, and you are fine.

5. TOOLS — EVERYTHING NAMED HERE IS AN EXAMPLE, NOT A REQUIREMENT

THE OPEN TOOLS POLICY

Every tool, format, template and technique named anywhere in this task is OPEN and fully substitutable. Nothing here is mandatory. If you prefer a different program, a different file format, a different diagram notation or a method you invented yourself, **use it** — provided the output is readable by your instructor and the reasoning is yours.

You are actively expected to:

- **research your own tools** rather than accept the first name on this page;
- **compare at least two options** before settling, and be able to say why;
- **build your own** where nothing fits — a twenty-line script that produces your scorecard is worth more to you than any product;
- **name your choice** in your dossier, in one sentence, with one reason.

No tool named below is endorsed, sponsored by, or affiliated with Cyber.SoHo Educational Hub in any way. Some are commercial, some are free, some are open-source. Check the licence yourself before you rely on anything.

Before you open any external link in this document, paste it into [VirusTotal](https://www.virustotal.com/gui/home/url) — <https://www.virustotal.com/gui/home/url> first. A link can be correct today and hostile tomorrow: domains expire and get re-registered, pages get compromised, shortened links hide where they go. Checking takes ten seconds.

5.1 What you actually need

Job	Some options	Notes
Writing the dossier	LibreOffice Writer — https://www.libreoffice.org · Microsoft Word · Google Docs · any Markdown editor · plain text	Markdown is fine and often faster. Export to PDF at the end.
Tables and scoring	LibreOffice Calc — https://www.libreoffice.org · Excel · Google Sheets · Gnumeric — http://www.gnumeric.org · a CSV file in a text editor	The Week 01 reference workbook already contains working scorecards.

Job	Some options	Notes
Diagrams	diagrams.net — https://www.diagrams.net · Excalidraw — https://excalidraw.com · Inkscape — https://inkscape.org · Mermaid — https://mermaid.js.org · Graphviz — https://graphviz.org · pen and paper, photographed	Hand-drawn and photographed is completely acceptable and loses no marks. Legibility is the only requirement.
Writing a small tool yourself	Python — https://www.python.org · JavaScript in a browser file · a shell script	Optional. Marks are for reasoning, not for code. But see §14.
Keeping sources straight	Zotero — https://www.zotero.org · a plain text file with URLs and dates	A plain text file is genuinely sufficient at this scale.
Exporting to PDF	LibreOffice · Word · your browser's Print → Save as PDF	Required for submission. See §11.

5.2 What you must not use

- **Anything that touches the target system beyond ordinary use.** See §4.
- **Any tool that collects personal data**, including analytics trackers, device fingerprinting utilities, or network capture tools.
- **A generative model as the author of your analysis.** See the academic integrity clause in §16.4. Using one as a dictionary or a grammar checker is fine and you do not need to declare it. Having one produce your findings, your scores, or your evidence is not, and it is straightforward to detect, because the evidence will not correspond to anything you actually observed.

6. CHOOSING YOUR SUBJECT — STEP 1 (LAB HOUR, 15 MINUTES)

This is the single highest-leverage decision in the whole project. A well-chosen subject makes Tasks 02 and 03 almost pleasant. A badly chosen one makes them grinding.

6.1 The three-candidate rule

Write down three candidate systems before choosing any of them. Not one. Three. The first system anybody thinks of is almost always either too large to observe or too small to have a process worth mapping.

For each candidate, answer these six questions with a yes or a no. Do it in a table so you can see the pattern:

#	Test	Why it matters
1	Can I use it legitimately, right now, as an ordinary user?	If no, the subject is out under §4.
2	Does it involve at least three different roles or departments ?	Under three, there are no handoffs, and A2 becomes impossible.
3	Can I observe at least one complete cycle — start to finish — in under thirty minutes?	You need a real observation, not a reconstruction from memory.
4	Does it produce something I can count ? Bookings, orders, minutes, queue length, error messages, clicks.	No countable output, no evidence, no marks on the double-weighted lens.
5	Does it collect any personal data at all ?	Almost all do. If genuinely none, A4 will be thin — prefer a different candidate.
6	Would I still find this interesting in three weeks?	You are stuck with it until 28 August.

Choose the candidate with the most yeses. On a tie, choose the one you can observe most often, not the one that sounds most impressive.

6.2 Subjects that work well

Library room booking. Campus print/photocopy credit. Student portal enrolment. Public bike-share. Transit fare card top-up and gate entry. Grocery click-and-collect. A pharmacy prescription refill flow. Gym class reservation. Restaurant table booking. Parcel locker collection. Municipal waste-collection scheduling. Cinema seat selection. A clinic appointment system.

6.3 Subjects that go badly, and why

Tempting subject	The problem
"Amazon" / "Google" / "Netflix"	Far too large. You cannot observe a cycle, you cannot see the process, and everything you write will come from press releases. Assess <i>one narrow flow</i> if you must — "the returns process", not "Amazon".
Your own hobby project	No organisation around it. No handoffs, no politics, no stakeholders. Lenses 2, 3 and 4 collapse.
Your employer's internal system	Blocked by §4.6 unless you have written permission from your employer, in which case attach it.
Anything you have to log into as somebody else	Blocked outright by §4.3.
A system you have never used	You will guess, and guessing is visible on the page.
Something with no competitors at all	Lens 4 has nothing to say. A pure monopoly can work, but say so and analyse <i>why</i> it is one.

6.4 Getting it locked

Write your chosen subject into the **A0 Subject Registration Sheet** (template in §12.1), post the one-line version in the course forum thread "*Task 01 — subject registrations*", and check that nobody else in the group has taken the identical system. Two students may assess the same *organisation* from different systems; two students may not assess the same *system*. First posted, first held.

7. THE LAB HOUR — STEPS 1 TO 4

Step 1 — Choose and lock your subject (15 min)

Do §6 above. Finish with one organisation and one system written down.

Step 2 — The twenty-minute observation run (20 min)

This is the most important twenty minutes of the task. Everything you later claim has to trace back to something in these notes.

Set a timer. Use the system through **one complete cycle**, start to finish, and capture as you go. Do not tidy your notes while you take them — tidy afterwards.

Record, in this order:

1. **Wall-clock start time**, to the minute.
2. **Every screen, form, counter, person or physical step**, in the order you meet them. Number them. "1. Landing page. 2. Login. 3. Date picker. 4. Room list."
3. **Every field you are asked for**, and beside each one a single letter: **R** if refusing it blocks the task, **O** if it is optional. This tiny annotation is what makes your data-minimisation argument possible in A4.
4. **Every wait**, with its length. "Queued 3 min 40 s at step 6."
5. **Every handoff you can detect** — anywhere the work visibly leaves one party and arrives at another. Confirmation email arriving = a handoff to a notification service. Staff member walking away to check = a handoff.
6. **Every error, retry, dead end or thing you had to guess.**
7. **Anything the system told you about itself.** Version numbers, "powered by X" footers, privacy notice links, terms-of-service links, cookie banners.
8. **Wall-clock end time**, and the total.

Take at least three counts. Number of steps. Number of required fields. Total elapsed seconds. Those three numbers are the seed of your evidence log, and an assessment with zero numbers in it cannot pass the Evidence lens.

If your first run is messy, that is the correct outcome. Note where it went wrong. A second, cleaner run during your personal hours is worth doing and gives you a before/after comparison for free — which is exactly what a baseline is for.

Step 3 — Register the subject and sign the declaration (15 min)

Fill in **A0** (template §12.1). It is one page. It includes a short declaration that you have read and will follow §4. Sign it — typing your name and the date counts. An unsigned A0 costs the full five marks and the task will be returned.

Step 4 — Build the dossier skeleton and check your tools (10 min)

Create the file you will hand in, with all eight headings already in it and nothing under them:

TASK01_<YourFamilyName>_<YourGivenName>_<StudentNumber>.pdf

```
A0  Subject Registration and Declaration
A1  System Anatomy
A2  Process Map
A3  Competitive Forces Scorecard
A4  Ethics Review
A5  Six-Lens Baseline Score
A6  Evidence Log
A7  Open Questions
```

Then confirm, now rather than at 23:50 on the fifteenth:

- ☐ Your editor can **export to PDF (Portable Document Format)**.
- ☐ Your diagram tool can **export an image you can place in the document**.
- ☐ You can **log in to Blackboard** and can see the *Assignments* → *DropBox* area.
- ☐ You know **what "midnight CET" is in your local time** (see §11.2).

8. PERSONAL BLOCK 1 — STEPS 5 AND 6

Step 5 — A1: System anatomy (30 min)

What you are producing: roughly 450–550 words plus one small diagram.

Work through these five questions in order. Write in full sentences — this is prose, not a form.

5.1 — The four activities. For your system, name each one concretely.

Activity	Answer the question
Input	What raw facts enter, from whom, through what?

Activity	Answer the question
Processing	What is done to them? Sorting, checking against stored records, calculating, matching?
Output	What reaches a person, in what form, and can they act on it?
Feedback	Does the output ever change what gets collected next time? Name the mechanism, or state plainly that you could not find one.

The feedback question is where most students lose marks on A1. "I assume there is a review process" is worth nothing. "I could find no evidence of any feedback mechanism visible to a user; the confirmation email invites no response and there is no visible complaint route" is worth full marks, because it is a finding.

5.2 — The three dimensions. Describe the system along all three. A system described only in technical terms has been described along one dimension out of three, and that earns very few marks — not because it is wrong, but because it is a third of an answer.

- **Organisation** — who is involved, what job titles, what written procedures, and what unwritten habits you could observe.
- **Management** — who decided this exists, who may use it, and what happens when it disagrees with a person.
- **Technology** — hardware, software, storage, networks, as far as an ordinary user can see. Guessing at the database is not an observation; say what you *saw*.

5.3 — Which system type. TPS, MIS, DSS or ESS? Justify by naming **the question it answers**, not by naming its features. Many real systems do several of these jobs; say which is dominant and why.

5.4 — Which business objectives. From the six — operational excellence; new products, services and business models; customer and supplier intimacy; improved decision making; competitive advantage; survival — name **exactly two** and defend them.

Two, precisely, beats six, vaguely. A project claiming all six objectives is almost always a project whose sponsor never decided what it was for. Claiming two and defending them scores higher than listing six.

5.5 — The diagram. One small figure showing input → processing → output → feedback for *your* system, with your real labels on the boxes. Hand-drawn and photographed is fine.

Step 6 — A2: Process map (30 min)

What you are producing: one swimlane diagram plus roughly 250–350 words.

6.1 — Pick one process, not the whole system. One complete sequence, start to finish. "Reserve a study room, use it, release it." "Order, collect, get charged."

6.2 — Identify at least three lanes. A lane is a role, team, department or external party. Typical lanes: the user; the front-line staff or interface; the operational function that fulfils it; finance or payments; a supplier or external service. If you cannot find three, your process is too narrow — widen it.

6.3 — Draw it. Lanes as horizontal bands, steps as boxes inside the correct lane, arrows for the flow. **Mark every arrow that crosses between lanes with a number** — those are your handoffs.

A minimal Mermaid starting point, if you want one to adapt:

```
flowchart LR
    subgraph USER
        U1[Requests a slot] --> U2[Receives confirmation]
    end
    subgraph FRONT_DESK
        F1[Checks availability] --> F2[Records booking]
    end
    subgraph OPERATIONS
        O1[Prepares the room]
    end
    U1 -->|handoff 1| F1
    F2 -->|handoff 2| O1
    F2 -->|handoff 3| U2
```

6.4 — Write the analysis. For **each** handoff you numbered:

- What information crosses?
- How does it cross — automatically, by message, by a person telling another person, or by somebody remembering?
- **What would break if it silently failed?** Would anyone notice? How soon?

Then close with one paragraph naming the **single weakest handoff** and saying how you would detect a failure there. Not how you would fix it — that is Task 03. How you would *detect* it.

6.5 — Enterprise application check. In two or three sentences: which of ERP, SCM, CRM or KMS does this process most resemble the job of, and is there any visible evidence the organisation runs one? "No visible evidence" is a perfectly good answer when it is what you found.

9. PERSONAL BLOCK 2 — STEPS 7 AND 8

Step 7 — A3: Competitive forces scorecard (30 min)

What you are producing: one table plus roughly 250–350 words.

Score each of the five forces from **1 to 5** for the organisation that runs your system, where **1** means the force barely affects them and **5** means it threatens their survival.

Beside every score, write one sentence of observable evidence. This is not a formatting preference. A score with no evidence sentence is marked as **zero**.

Force	Score 1–5	Evidence — one sentence of observable fact	System that would reduce this force
Rivalry among existing competitors			
Threat of new market entrants			
Threat of substitute products or services			
Bargaining power of customers			
Bargaining power of suppliers			
Total pressure	/25		

What counts as evidence at your level. You are an undergraduate with no access to their accounts, and nobody expects otherwise. Acceptable evidence includes: the number of directly comparable alternatives within a defined distance or a defined search; published prices you can compare; whether stored value, saved history or accumulated credit makes leaving costly, and roughly how costly; whether a substitute exists that you personally have used instead; publicly stated supplier or partner names. **Unacceptable:** "the market is very competitive."

Then write the analysis. Which single force is strongest? What is that force costing them, in terms you can observe? Which of the four generic strategies — low-cost leadership, product differentiation, focus on a market niche, customer and supplier intimacy — does their system appear to serve? And, honestly, is there a force your system does **nothing** about?

Name the row that did not move. An analysis showing improvement everywhere is usually an analysis where the scoring was done after the conclusion. The single most credible sentence you can write in A3 is the one admitting what the system does not address.

The framework is Michael E. Porter's. Cite him. The authoritative source is the [Institute for Strategy and Competitiveness, Harvard Business School — https://www.isc.hbs.edu](https://www.isc.hbs.edu).

Step 8 — A4: Ethics review (30 min)

What you are producing: roughly 400–500 words, structured in three parts.

8.1 — The five moral dimensions. One or two sentences on each, specific to your system. If a dimension genuinely does not apply, say so and say why — that is a finding, not a gap.

Dimension	The question to answer for your system
Information rights and obligations	What is collected? What is disclosed before collection? What can a person see, correct or delete about themselves?
Property rights and obligations	Who owns the data and anything derived from it? What do the terms of service say?
Accountability, liability and control	When it goes wrong, who answers? Is there a named human who can reverse an automatic decision?
System quality	What error rate is acceptable here, given what an error does to a person? Did you see any errors?
Quality of life	What does this change about how people behave, wait, queue, or relate to each other?

8.2 — The five-step analysis, applied to exactly one issue. Choose the single sharpest ethical question your system raises — usually a field collected that the task does not require, or an automatic decision with no visible appeal. Then work the five steps, writing each one down.

1. **The facts.** Who does what, to whom, when, how. Most apparent ethical disputes turn out to be factual disputes wearing an ethical costume, and this step dissolves them.
2. **The conflict, and the higher-order values.** Rarely good against bad. Usually one legitimate value against another — safety against privacy, efficiency against fairness. Name **both**.
3. **The stakeholders.** Everybody with an interest, including somebody who is not in the room. This is the step most often skipped and the one that most changes the answer.
4. **The options.** There are almost never two. Find at least **four**. The good one is usually the third.
5. **The consequences of each option,** for each stakeholder — not only for the organisation.

8.3 — Apply two principles that disagree. Choose **two** of the six candidate principles — the Golden Rule; Kant's Categorical Imperative; the Slippery Slope Rule; the Utilitarian Principle; the Risk Aversion Principle; the "No Free Lunch" Rule — that point in **different** directions. Apply both. Say which you would follow and why.

Do not list all six. An analysis in which every principle agrees is usually an analysis of an easy case. Choosing two that conflict is the demonstration of judgement, and judgement is what is being marked.

8.4 — The accountability check. One sentence, answering one question: **is there a named human who can reverse an automatic decision this system makes?** If you cannot find one, say so — you have identified an accountability gap, which is a design defect regardless of how accurate the system is.

Useful authorities. Cite them properly where you use them:

- [Office of the Privacy Commissioner of Canada](https://www.priv.gc.ca) — <https://www.priv.gc.ca>
 - [Commission d'accès à l'information du Québec](https://www.cai.gouv.qc.ca) — <https://www.cai.gouv.qc.ca>
 - [European Data Protection Supervisor](https://www.edps.europa.eu) — <https://www.edps.europa.eu>
 - [ACM \(Association for Computing Machinery\) Code of Ethics](https://www.acm.org/code-of-ethics) — <https://www.acm.org/code-of-ethics>
 - [IEEE \(Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers\)](https://www.ieee.org) — <https://www.ieee.org>
 - [CIPS \(Canadian Information Processing Society\)](https://www.cips.ca) — <https://www.cips.ca>
 - [NIST \(National Institute of Standards and Technology\) Privacy Framework](https://www.nist.gov/privacy-framework) — <https://www.nist.gov/privacy-framework>
 - [OECD \(Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development\)](https://www.oecd.org) — <https://www.oecd.org>
 - [WIPO \(World Intellectual Property Organization\)](https://www.wipo.int) — <https://www.wipo.int>
-

10. PERSONAL BLOCK 3 — STEPS 9 TO 11

Step 9 — A5: Six-lens baseline score (20 min)

Score **your own assessment** — not the system — against the six lenses. You are grading the quality of the work you have just done. This is deliberately uncomfortable and it is how professionals find their own gaps before somebody else does.

Lens	The question it answers	Weight	Your score /10	Your finding (2–3 sentences)
1. Purpose	Which business objectives does this system serve?	×1		
2. People	Who inputs, who decides, who is affected?	×1		
3. Process	Which steps does it change, remove or create?	×1		
4. Strategy	Which competitive force does it weaken?	×1		
5. Ethics	Whose data, whose risk, whose accountability?	×2		
6. Evidence	What measurement proves each claim is true?	×2		
		/80		

The four rules that govern this table:

1. A lens you skip is a mark you lose. All six, every time.
2. Ethics and Evidence carry double weight — those are where real assessments fail.
3. **A score with no written finding scores zero.** Not reduced. Zero.
4. **Report the weakest lens, not the average.** Close A5 with one sentence naming your lowest-scoring lens and what you would do first to raise it.

The Week 01 reference workbook (Week01_IS_Reference_Workbook.xlsx, sheet 05 Six-Lens TOOL) does this arithmetic for you, including the zero-if-unevidenced rule. Use it, or reproduce it in whatever you prefer.

Step 10 — A6 evidence log and A7 open questions (20 min)

A6 — The evidence log. Minimum eight rows. Every claim you made anywhere in A1 to A5 that a sceptical reader could challenge gets a row here.

#	Claim (where it appears)	Measurement or observation	How obtained	Date & time	Confidence
1	"Booking takes six steps" (A2)	Counted 6 distinct screens	Direct observation, one full cycle	2026-08-05, 14:20	High
2	"Three of nine fields are optional" (A1)	9 fields, 3 marked optional	Direct observation	2026-08-05, 14:23	High
3	...				

Confidence is **High** (you measured it yourself, more than once), **Medium** (you measured it once, or read it from an official source), or **Low** (inferred). **Low confidence entries are welcome and cost you nothing, provided they are labelled.** Unlabelled guesses presented as fact cost a great deal.

A7 — Open questions. Minimum three. For each: state what you could not determine, why you could not, and **precisely what you would need** to determine it.

"I could not establish whether the MAC (Media Access Control) address is retained after a booking closes, because the privacy notice does not mention retention periods. To answer this I would need either the organisation's retention schedule or a formal access request under PIPEDA."

That paragraph earns marks. "Everything was clear" earns none, and is never true.

Step 11 — Assemble, self-mark, export, submit (20 min)

1. Put A0 to A7 in order in one document.
2. Add a cover line: your name, student number, course, task, date, subject system.
3. **Self-mark against §13 and write your own total at the top.** Students who do this land within a few marks of the real grade, and the exercise of doing it catches more errors than proofreading does.

4. Read your own A1 to A5 with one question in mind: *which sentences here could a sceptical reader not check?* Rewrite each one until they could, or delete it.
5. Export to **PDF**. Check the diagrams survived the export and are legible.
6. Submit to Blackboard. See §11.
7. **Download your own submission and open it.** Corrupt or empty uploads are the commonest avoidable disaster in this course, and they are always discovered too late.

11. SUBMISSION

11.1 Where

Blackboard → **this course** → **Assignments** → **DropBox** → **"Task 01 — Baseline Assessment"**. Nowhere else. Not by email. An emailed submission is not a submission.

11.2 When



MIDNIGHT CET, SUNDAY 16 AUGUST 2026

That means the end of Sunday the sixteenth in Central European Time — in other words, **23:59 CET on 16 August**.

Know your own clock. Central Europe observes summer time in August, and Montréal is six hours behind it. If you are working in Montréal, the safe reading is **late afternoon on Saturday 15 August, local time**. If you are anywhere else, work it out today, not on the day.

My advice, which costs you nothing: submit on Friday. The DropBox will accept an early submission and will let you replace it. Nobody has ever regretted submitting early. Several people every term regret the opposite.

11.3 What

Requirement	Specification
Format	PDF — one file
File name	TASK01_FamilyName_GivenName_StudentNumber.pdf
Length	1,700 – 2,200 words of prose, plus tables and figures (which do not count toward the word budget)
Figures	At least two (the A1 anatomy diagram and the A2 swimlane)
Tables	At least three (A3 scorecard, A5 lens table, A6 evidence log)
Anonymisation	Applied wherever §4.7 requires it
Declaration	A0 signed and dated

11.4 Late work

Late submissions are handled under the course's standard late policy in the Course Plan. If something serious happens, tell me **before** the deadline rather than after it — the options available before midnight are considerably better than the options available afterwards.

12. TEMPLATES

12.1 A0 — Subject Registration and Declaration

A0 SUBJECT REGISTRATION AND DECLARATION

Student
Student number
Date

ORGANISATION
SYSTEM (be narrow)
ORGANISATION TYPE (public / private / non-profit / educational / other)
APPROXIMATE SIZE (people served, sites, or "unknown – estimated from ...")

HOW I ACCESS IT (as an ordinary user / as an enrolled student / other)
ANONYMISED? (yes / no – if yes, state the pseudonym used and why)

WHY THIS SUBJECT (three sentences maximum)
1. It involves at least three roles or departments, namely:
2. I can observe one complete cycle in under 30 minutes because:
3. It produces something countable, namely:

THE TWO OTHER CANDIDATES I CONSIDERED AND REJECTED
Candidate 2: – rejected because
Candidate 3: – rejected because

DECLARATION
I have read section 4 of the Task 01 exercise, "The Rules of Engagement".
I will observe this system only as an ordinary user is entitled to.
I will not attempt any security testing, unauthorised access, scraping or automated collection of any kind.
I will collect no personal data about any identifiable individual.
I will not use confidential or employer-internal material.
I will not publish this dossier anywhere outside the course DropBox.
The analysis I submit is my own work, and every source is cited.

Signed Date

12.2 A6 — Evidence log, empty

#	Claim (and where it appears)	Measurement or observation	How obtained	Date & time	Confidence
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					
6					
7					
8					

13. HOW TASK 01 IS MARKED

100 points, scaled to 10% of the final grade.

Part	What is assessed	Points
A0 Registration & declaration	Complete, three candidates shown, signed	5
A1 System anatomy	Four activities named concretely; feedback answered honestly; all three dimensions present; system type justified by the question it answers; exactly two objectives defended; diagram legible	15
A2 Process map	Three or more lanes; handoffs numbered; each handoff analysed for failure and detection; weakest handoff named; enterprise application check present	12
A3 Competitive forces	Five scores; an evidence sentence beside every one ; strongest force identified; generic strategy argued; a force the system does not address is named	13
A4 Ethics review — double weight	Five dimensions addressed specifically; five-step analysis worked on one issue with four or more options; two <i>conflicting</i> principles applied; accountability check answered	20
A5 Six-lens baseline	All six scored; a written finding beside every score; weakest lens named with a first action	10
A6 Evidence log — double weight	Eight or more rows; claims traceable; confidence labelled honestly; dates present	20
A7 Open questions	Three or more; each states what is missing and what would be needed	5

Part	What is assessed	Points
		100

13.1 What earns marks

- A specific measurement behind every claim.
- At least one thing the system does **not** do well.
- At least one question you could not answer, with what you would need.
- Naming a stakeholder nobody else would think of.
- A confidence label of "Low" on something you genuinely inferred.
- Disagreeing with something in the lecture, in writing, with evidence.

13.2 What loses marks

- Adjectives standing in for measurements: "very efficient", "user-friendly", "seamless", "robust".
- Claiming all six business objectives.
- Any lens left blank.
- A score anywhere with no evidence sentence beside it — that score is zero.
- Describing only the technology dimension.
- A process map with no handoffs marked.
- An ethics section that concludes everything is fine. Something is never fine; find it.
- Copying the fictional case studies from the lecture. They exist to show you the shape of an answer, not to be an answer. Reusing Atwater Bike Repair, Rue Sherbrooke Café, Boba Boulevard, Pearl & Co., StudySpot or LibreDesk as your subject scores zero.

14. OPTIONAL EXTENSIONS — NOT MARKED, GENUINELY WORTH DOING

None of this affects your grade. All of it makes Tasks 02 and 03 easier, and two of them are the sort of thing that ends up on a portfolio.

- **Run the observation twice**, a week apart, at different times of day. Compare. You now have a trend rather than a snapshot, and trends are what Task 03 wants.
- **Write your own scorecard tool**. Twenty lines of Python, or a single self-contained HTML file, that takes your five force scores plus evidence strings and refuses to output a total when an evidence string is empty. Enforcing the rule in code teaches it better than obeying it does.
- **Build the swimlane in a text format** — Mermaid, Graphviz DOT, or your own notation — so it lives in version control and diffs cleanly between Task 01 and Task 03.
- **Read one privacy notice end to end**, timing yourself, and record the word count. Put the number in your evidence log. It will be more useful than you expect during A4.

- **Find the organisation's actual published numbers** if they publish any — annual reports, open-data portals, municipal dashboards. An assessment that cites the organisation's own published figure against your own measurement is a strong assessment.
 - **Invent a better lens.** If the six do not capture something important about your subject, propose a seventh, define its question, and say what it would measure. Bring it to the next lecture.
-

15. LINK DIRECTORY

Scan every one of these through [VirusTotal](https://www.virustotal.com/gui/home/url) — <https://www.virustotal.com/gui/home/url> before opening.

Professional bodies and codes of conduct

- [ACM \(Association for Computing Machinery\)](https://www.acm.org) — <https://www.acm.org> — and the Code of Ethics at <https://www.acm.org/code-of-ethics>
- [IEEE \(Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers\)](https://www.ieee.org) — <https://www.ieee.org>
- [IEEE Computer Society](https://www.computer.org) — <https://www.computer.org>
- [CIPS \(Canadian Information Processing Society\)](https://www.cips.ca) — <https://www.cips.ca>

Privacy regulators and data protection authorities

- [Office of the Privacy Commissioner of Canada](https://www.priv.gc.ca) — <https://www.priv.gc.ca>
- [Commission d'accès à l'information du Québec](https://www.cai.gouv.qc.ca) — <https://www.cai.gouv.qc.ca>
- [European Data Protection Supervisor](https://www.edps.europa.eu) — <https://www.edps.europa.eu>
- [EUR-Lex, official EU legal texts including the GDPR](https://eur-lex.europa.eu) — <https://eur-lex.europa.eu>

Standards, intergovernmental and government bodies

- [NIST \(National Institute of Standards and Technology\) Privacy Framework](https://www.nist.gov/privacy-framework) — <https://www.nist.gov/privacy-framework>
- [ISO \(International Organization for Standardization\)](https://www.iso.org) — <https://www.iso.org>
- [OECD \(Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development\)](https://www.oecd.org) — <https://www.oecd.org>
- [WIPO \(World Intellectual Property Organization\)](https://www.wipo.int) — <https://www.wipo.int>
- [Canadian Intellectual Property Office](https://ised-isde.canada.ca/site/canadian-intellectual-property-office/en) — <https://ised-isde.canada.ca/site/canadian-intellectual-property-office/en>

Strategy and research

- [Institute for Strategy and Competitiveness, Harvard Business School](https://www.isc.hbs.edu) — <https://www.isc.hbs.edu>

- [MIT Sloan Management Review — https://sloanreview.mit.edu](https://sloanreview.mit.edu)
- [Open Textbook Library — https://open.umn.edu/opentextbooks](https://open.umn.edu/opentextbooks)

Tools mentioned as examples only

- [LibreOffice — https://www.libreoffice.org](https://www.libreoffice.org)
- [diagrams.net — https://www.diagrams.net](https://www.diagrams.net)
- [Excalidraw — https://excalidraw.com](https://excalidraw.com)
- [Inkscape — https://inkscape.org](https://inkscape.org)
- [Mermaid — https://mermaid.js.org](https://mermaid.js.org)
- [Graphviz — https://graphviz.org](https://graphviz.org)
- [Python — https://www.python.org](https://www.python.org)
- [Zotero — https://www.zotero.org](https://www.zotero.org)
- [Gnumeric — http://www.gnumeric.org](http://www.gnumeric.org)
- [Creative Commons — https://creativecommons.org](https://creativecommons.org)

Safety

- [VirusTotal URL scanner — https://www.virustotal.com/gui/home/url](https://www.virustotal.com/gui/home/url)

16. DISCLAIMER, COPYRIGHT AND LEGAL NOTICE

Please read this section. It protects you as much as it protects the author.

16.1 Ownership of this material — Intellectual Property

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16.4 Academic integrity, and the use of generative tools

The work you submit must be yours. Using a generative model as a dictionary, a grammar checker or a study partner is fine and needs no declaration. Having one produce your findings, your scores, your evidence or your prose is academic misconduct under the institution's policy, and it will be visible: generated evidence does not correspond to anything you actually observed, and the evidence log in A6 exists partly for that reason. Cite every source you use — including any generative tool that materially shaped your text — and cite it honestly. If you are unsure whether something needs declaring, declare it; nobody has ever been penalised for over-disclosing.

16.5 Lawful and ethical conduct — this is the clause that matters most

This task requires you to observe a real organisation's system. **Section 4, "The Rules of Engagement", forms part of the assessment requirements and is binding.** Nothing in this document authorises, encourages or excuses: unauthorised access to any computer system, service or account; security testing, probing, scanning or interception of any kind; circumvention of access controls, rate limits or terms of service; automated scraping or bulk collection; the collection, retention or disclosure of personal data about any identifiable individual; or the use of confidential, proprietary or employer-internal material. Such conduct may constitute an offence under the **Criminal Code of Canada**, under Québec, European Union and United States law, and under equivalent legislation elsewhere, and may breach the institution's own code of conduct. **You alone are responsible for what you do.** Cyber.SoHo Educational Hub, the author and the institution accept no liability for any act taken by a student in connection with this task, and any such act is undertaken entirely outside the scope of this material and against its explicit written instructions.

16.6 No professional advice

This is educational material for an undergraduate course. It is **not** legal advice, privacy advice, compliance advice, security advice, financial advice or professional consulting advice, and it must not be relied upon as any of those. Summaries of legislation and regulatory frameworks are simplified for teaching, are not complete, are not a substitute for reading the instrument itself, and may be out of date by the time you read them. For any real decision, consult a qualified professional in the relevant jurisdiction.

16.7 Fictional scenarios

Every case study, organisation, person, figure and dataset used in the Week 01 lecture materials — including Atwater Bike Repair, Rue Sherbrooke Café, Boba Boulevard, Pearl & Co., StudySpot, LibreDesk and Sainte-Geneviève College — is **entirely fictional**, created solely for teaching. Any resemblance to a real organisation, product, person or event is coincidental and unintended. They are illustrations of a method, not claims about anybody.

16.8 Frameworks, models and prior scholarship

This task applies established frameworks that are the intellectual contribution of their originators, credited where used. The five competitive forces and the value chain are the work of **Michael E. Porter** — see the [Institute for Strategy and Competitiveness, Harvard Business School — https://www.isc.hbs.edu](https://www.isc.hbs.edu). The moral dimensions and the five-step ethical analysis reflect the standard treatment in the management information systems literature. Where those frameworks are described here, the wording, structuring, examples and application are original; no published text is reproduced. Students citing these frameworks in their own work must cite the original authors, not this document.

16.9 Tools and technical content

All tools, formats and techniques named here are examples only, offered as starting points. They are **open and fully substitutable** — you are expected to research alternatives, compare them, and build your own where nothing fits. No tool is endorsed. Licences, terms, pricing, availability and safety are the user's responsibility to verify. Any code or template supplied with this course is provided **"AS IS"**, **without warranty of any kind**, express or implied, including any warranty of merchantability, fitness for a particular purpose or non-infringement. Run nothing you have not read.

16.10 Accuracy, currency and change

This field moves. Legislation is amended, regulators reorganise, organisations restructure, links rot. Every reasonable effort has been made to be accurate at the version date shown at the top of this document, but no warranty of accuracy, completeness or currency is given. Where this material and a primary source disagree, **the primary source is correct**.

16.11 Data protection and the exercises

No exercise in this task requires you to collect, transmit or store personal data about any identifiable person, and you are instructed not to. Anything you write in your dossier is yours; you submit it to the course DropBox and nowhere else. Do not include personal data about third parties in a submission. Where anonymisation is required under §4.7, apply it before the notes become part of the document, not after.

16.12 Accessibility and equity

No part of this task requires paid software, a specific operating system, a specific device, or an internet connection beyond what is needed to submit. Hand-drawn diagrams are fully acceptable. If any element of this task presents a barrier to you for any reason — access, disability, caring responsibilities, working hours, language — **contact me before the deadline** and an equivalent alternative will be arranged. That is a standing offer and it does not require an explanation.

16.13 Severability and governing law

If any provision of this notice is found unenforceable, the remaining provisions remain in full force. This notice is governed by the laws of the Province of Québec and the federal laws of Canada applicable therein, without prejudice to any mandatory consumer or student protection available to you where you live.

16.14 Contact

Questions about this task go to the course forum first, so that the answer helps everybody. Anything personal, or anything under §16.12, comes directly to me.